

NYDAM PHOTOGRAPHY · CLASS OF 2027

COMPLIMENTARY DOWNLOAD

How to Prepare for Your Senior Session.

A practical guide for seniors and their families.

- Planning outfits that photograph well.
- Hair, makeup & grooming — what to do and when.
 - What to bring on session day.
- Timing & light — when we shoot, and why.
- How to feel confident in front of the camera.
 - What to expect from your gallery.
 - Why Nydam Photography.

NYDAM PHOTOGRAPHY

"Genuine. Intentional. Timeless."

nydamphoto.com · Austin, Texas · Est. 2008

WELCOME

Everything Your Senior Needs to Show Up Ready.

A guide for seniors and their families.

NYDAM PHOTOGRAPHY

“Eighteen years. Thousands of sessions. The best senior portraits start long before the shutter — with a little preparation that lets your senior simply relax and be themselves.”

A great senior session is part light, part styling, and part feeling comfortable enough to be yourself. This guide walks through all three — the outfits, the timing, the small details — so nothing is left to chance and your senior can just enjoy the day.

Use it to plan with confidence. Everything here is exactly what we'd tell a senior in our own family.

WHAT'S INSIDE

- 01 Planning Your Outfits
- 02 Hair, Makeup & Grooming
- 03 What to Bring
- 04 Timing & Light
- 05 Feeling Confident on Camera

NP SENIORS — ALL-INCLUSIVE

Hair & makeup included. You show up. We handle everything — from the pre-session plan to the final gallery.

01 Planning Your Outfits.

Outfits do more to shape a senior session than almost anything else. The goal is range — a few looks that feel like different sides of the same person.

WHAT TO BRING

- + Two to four outfits. A casual look, a dressier look, and one tied to a real interest.
- + Pieces that fit well. Confidence reads on camera; so does discomfort.
- + Shoes & accessories. The small things that finish each look.
- + A go-to favorite. The outfit your senior feels most themselves in.

WHAT WORKS ON CAMERA

- + Solid, muted tones. They photograph cleaner than busy patterns or neon.
- + Texture and layers. More interesting than loud, trendy prints.
- + Location-matched looks. Polished for urban, relaxed for natural settings.
- + Nothing brand new. Wear it once before the session, if you can.

STYLIST TIP

Lay every outfit out the night before — complete, head to toe, including shoes and accessories. It removes the morning scramble and guarantees nothing gets forgotten.

02 Hair, Makeup & Grooming.

Whatever makes your senior feel most like themselves is the right call. Professional styling is optional — but many seniors love the polish and the confidence it brings.

IF YOU BOOK STYLING

- + Time it right. Schedule it to finish shortly before the session start.
- + Bring a reference. A photo of the look you're going for helps everyone.
- + Trust the pros. Our stylists know what reads beautifully on camera.

IF YOU'RE DOING IT YOURSELF

- + Go a touch stronger. The camera reads makeup lighter than the mirror does.
- + Guys: fresh cut early. About a week out — not the day before.
- + Pack touch-ups. A comb, powder for shine, and a hair tie.

GOOD TO KNOW

A natural, everyday version of your senior almost always ages better in photos than a heavily done look. When in doubt, keep it simple.

03 What to Bring.

A little packing goes a long way. Have these ready the night before so session day is calm and unhurried.

THE ESSENTIALS

- + All outfits, pressed. On hangers if you can — wrinkles show up in photos.
- + Story props. An instrument, a jersey, a letterman jacket, a pet (ask first).
- + Water & a snack. Especially for a longer session.

THE LITTLE THINGS

- + Touch-up kit. Comb, powder, hair ties, safety pins.
- + Comfortable shoes. For walking between locations.
- + A great attitude. Relaxed sessions are more fun — and more flattering.

04 Timing & Light.

We usually photograph in the last hour or two before sunset, when the light is soft, warm, and forgiving. We'll confirm your exact time when we plan the session.

GOOD TO KNOW

Arrive a few minutes early and already in the first outfit. It means we can spend the very best light on photos — not on changing clothes.

05 Feeling Confident on Camera.

Nobody arrives knowing how to pose — and no one needs to. We direct posture, hands, angles, and expression the entire time, so your senior is never left guessing.

WHAT WE HANDLE

- + Every pose. Where to stand, where to look, what to do with your hands.
- + Expression. We'll get the genuine smile and the softer look both.
- + The pace. Enough time to relax into it, never rushed.

WHAT HELPS AT HOME

- + Rest & water. The day before genuinely shows up in the photos.
- + Practice a little. A relaxed smile and a softer, no-teeth look.
- + Trust the process. The best frames come once the performing stops.

REMEMBER

Outfits that fit, light that flatters, and a senior who feels at ease — get those three right and the rest takes care of itself.

WHEN YOU'RE READY

Ready to Plan the Session?

We're happy to talk through outfits, timing, and locations before your session — whatever your senior's style. When you're ready, here's how to begin.

BEGIN

- + Check availability. nydamphoto.com/book
- + Explore senior portraits.
nydamphoto.com/seniors
- + Call or text. 512-955-4520

THE THREE PILLARS

- + **Genuine.** Portraits that feel like your senior — not a polished stranger.
- + **Intentional.** Every light, pose, and detail planned with care.
- + **Timeless.** Edited for longevity, not for trends.

KNOW SOMEONE WHO DESERVES THIS?

Pass this guide along, or send them straight to us. A referral from a family we've worked with is the highest compliment we receive. — With warmth, Arlen & Tanya Nydam

GENUINE. INTENTIONAL. TIMELESS.

nydamphoto.com · tatiana.nydam@gmail.com · 512-955-4520